

Assignment 3: Project Presentation and Peer Assessment

In this assessment task, you will present your Assignment 2 (A2) project to your peers and simultaneously act as an assessor for your classmates' projects. For each project you assess, you will evaluate the quality based on three criteria outlined below (refer to the A2 specification and the attached detailed guidelines for more details).

- A: Task definition.
- B: Implementation and technical details
- C: Evaluation, conclusion and reflection

You will rank each criterion as “Poor,” “Fair,” or “Excellent” and provide comments to justify your rankings. Additionally, you will receive rankings and feedback from your peers and a tutor for your own project.

The peer-presentation and assessment consists of 3 stages:

1. Preparation (1-2 Days Before Presentation)

You will receive the following materials:

- **Presentation Information:** Includes your **presenter index** (e.g., “P1,” “P2,” ..., “P6”), **Zoom session number, and presentation time**. **Immediate Action:** Verify that you are the intended recipient by checking the student ID in the message.
- **Peer Reports:** Reports from your presentation group, which consists of approximately six students from the same time slot. Note that the specific groupings will **not** be disclosed in advance.
- **Grading Sheet:** A template for assessing your peers' projects (see attached).

Action Items:

- Review (browsing suffices) the journals and projects you have received.
- Prepare a **tentative evaluation** for each criterion of A2. It is fine to be UNCLEAR on some/all criteria at this stage.
- If there is unclarity which you deem to be significant. Please **prepare questions** to ask in the presentation session.

2. Presentation Day

On the day of the presentation:

- **Join the Online Session:** Log in to the specified Zoom session at your designated time.
- **Identification:** Present your student ID or another form of photo ID to verify your identity.
- **Present Your Project:** Share your A2 project with the group and address any questions from your peers and the tutor.

Important Notes:

- Effective communication of your project is crucial for accurate grading. Refer to the “Grading” section for detailed criteria.
- The criteria for evaluating presentations, question answering, and comment giving pertain to Assignment 3 (A3). Ensure you differentiate these from the A2 assessment criteria.

After Your Presentation:

- Summarize your observations and feedback.
- Submit the final grading sheet based on your assessments.

3. Post-Presentation and Grading

Within a week (often much shorter, depending on when peers submit their grading sheets), you will receive a summary from the tutor detailing the A2 grades for your group. This summary will include:

- **A2 Comments and Rankings:** Your project's peer assessments, as well as from tutor. This is strongly indicative to the final grade of A2.
- **A3 Comments and Rankings Part-1:** Part of assessments of your Assignment 3 – as a presenter.
- **A3 Comments and Rankings Part-2:** The remaining of your A3 will depend on your contribution to the peer-grading process. This includes:
 - Providing constructive and critical feedback to your peers.
 - Actively participating in the assessment process.

Note: The final portion of your A3 grade may be received slightly later, depending on when you submit your comments to others.

We will release grades of A2 and A3 in 2 weeks after the presentation.

Procedure of the Presentation Sessions

1. Project Presentation

- **Duration:** Each presenter has **5 minutes** to present their project.
- **Overtime Policy:** Presentations exceeding 5 minutes but not surpassing 7 minutes are discouraged and may result in a lower A3 grade (refer to Criterion 1 below).
- **Enforcement:** The session chair will **end the presentation at 7 minutes** if necessary.

2. Question and Answer Session

- **Purpose:** Peers will ask questions to:
 1. Clarify relevant points about the project.
 2. Assess how the project aligns with the A2 criteria.
 3. Determine whether the author demonstrates genuine effort, understanding, and critical thinking.
- **Duration:** This session will last approximately **10 minutes**, depending on the number of questions and presentation length.
- **Activities for All Students:**

Take Notes: Document key points and insights from the presentation and Q&A to adjust your tentative evaluations of the A2 criteria. This is the best time to identify whether the project reflects the author's own understanding and effort or merely compiles external materials.

Assess Presentation Skills: Evaluate the presenter's ability to communicate effectively and handle questions (refer to A3 Criteria below).

Observe Peer Engagement: Note the activity levels of other students, such as asking relevant questions and providing constructive feedback.

- **Timing:**

The Q&A session ends after 15 minutes after the presentation starts. In case of an overtime presentation, the Q&A session will end **17 minutes** after the presentation starts, including any overtime.

3. Session Transition

Tutor's Role: After the Q&A session, the tutor will **summarize the project** and provide any additional feedback.

Time Allocation: The tutor will conclude the current session and **initiate the next presentation within 3 minutes** to ensure the schedule remains on track.

Criteria

These criteria apply to the **Presentation** and **Peer-Grading Sessions** of Assignment 3 (A3). **Do not confuse these with the A2 Criteria**, which primarily assess the quality of your project work.

1. Effective Communication ("Spot-on")

- **Clarity and Conciseness:** Present your project **clearly and concisely**, focusing on how it addresses the A2 criteria (refer to the A2 specification and attached grading guidelines).
- **Content Focus:** Ensure that your presentation highlights the implementation of the A2 criteria, demonstrating a thorough understanding of your project.
- **Time Management:**
 - **Standard Duration:** Each presentation should last **5 minutes**.
 - **Overtime Policy:** Presentations exceeding 5 minutes but not surpassing 7 minutes are discouraged and will incur an overtime penalty:
Penalty Details: Up to **20% reduction** in the A3 grade, calculated as **2 points per minute** over the allotted time (e.g., a 2-minute overtime results in a 4-point penalty).
 - **Enforcement:** The session chair will **terminate the presentation at 7 minutes** if necessary.

2. Handling Questions

- **Response Quality:** Answer questions **accurately and concisely**, demonstrating a clear understanding of the topic.
- **Criterion Weighting:**
 - **Correctness:** 50% of this criterion is based on the accuracy and relevance of your responses.
 - **Conciseness:** 50% is based on the brevity and clarity of your answers.
- **Expected Responses:**
 - **Adequate Response:** Providing a direct and accurate answer, even if it means acknowledging uncertainty (e.g., "I understand the question, but I need to research the exact details.") will receive **50% credit**.
 - **Inadequate Response:** Offering lengthy, vague, or irrelevant answers that do not address the question will receive **0% credit**.

- **Examples:**
 - “You mention to add regularisation penalizing complexity and claim it will help learning, why?”
 - **Good Response:** "More complex models are more able to fit to data, including data containing unwanted relationships, i.e. noises, enforcing simple models will eliminate the influence from such data."
 - **Good Response - 2:** "I don't know. ChatGPT states so. I can ask for reference to check the correctness or find out the origin of this idea."
 - **Poor Response:** "Yes, the regularization technique we implemented helps prevent overfitting by adding a penalty for more complex models, aligning with our goal of enhancing generalization. " (It is a tautology of the question. The argument is loopy. This is a “good example” generated by ChatGPT!)
 - **Poor Response - 2:** "That's an interesting question. I think it relates to the model-bias. ... (irrelevant "dodging" discussion)"
- 3. **Active and Constructive Peer Grading**
 - **Engagement:** Actively participate in the peer-grading process by thoughtfully evaluating your classmates' presentations.
 - **Constructive Feedback:** Provide **constructive and actionable feedback**, highlighting both strengths and areas for improvement. The feedback needs to be recorded in the assessment table that you return to the tutor and submit to A3.
 - **Criteria Alignment:** Ensure that your feedback is aligned with the established A2/A3 criteria, focusing on aspects such as communication effectiveness, question handling, and overall presentation skills.

Tips

1. **Prepare the Presentation Concisely**
 Since everyone in the session is part of the same class and "insiders," focus on clarifying the **inputs, desired outputs, and how to evaluate when the model output differs from the desired ones**. This approach will help everyone understand your project without unnecessary details.
2. **Use Few Slides and Pre-Run Your Project**
 Keep your slides to a minimum and ensure you pre-run your project. This practice helps save time on data loading and activating execution kernels, making your presentation smoother and more efficient.
3. **Avoid Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)**
 - Steer clear of showcasing "impressive" statistics that you might find on data cards from platforms like Kaggle. If the statistics are easily obtainable and not linked to your design in an insightful way, they add little value. For example, you don't need to mention that the class is imbalanced unless you've employed methods to handle it.
 - **With careful planning and following points 1, 2, and 3, you can effectively cover “what this project is about, my solution, and the outcome” within 3 minutes.**
4. **Allocate ~2 Minutes to a Key Point**
 Dedicate about **2 minutes** to highlight a particular aspect of your project that you truly invested effort in studying. Remember, **half or more of your A3 grade** is about convincing others that the project is **YOUR** work. It's essential to let

reviewers firmly believe you invented it, designed it, and understand it deeply. Don't let the desire to "show a big project" undermine your own purpose, as this can lead to poor grades in both A3 and A2.

5. **Include "Baits-for-Questions" in Your Presentation**

For particularly interesting points in your project, leave a few "baits-for-questions" during your presentation. It's important to **communicate how the project fits the criteria**, and having questions from the audience can be more effective than making statements yourself.

Miscellaneous Points

1. **Peer Grading Integrity**

Tutor and Coordinator Involvement: Tutors and the subject coordinator **will NOT interfere** with peer gradings unless there is **intentional damage to academic integrity** or a **lack of supportive arguments** (see below). This means that any individual peer's opinion in the grading is weighted at a small portion (~10%, depending on the group size) but will still be respected.

2. **Moderation of Rankings**

Ensuring Fairness: Rankings will be moderated to ensure that similar projects receive similar grades. This moderation will follow three steps:

- **Validation of Extreme Rankings:** Rankings that are **straight 'poor' or 'excellent' in all criteria** will be removed unless supported by **substantial arguments**. Additionally, the ranker's grade in **A3 Criterion 3** will be penalized for unsupported extreme rankings.
- **Tutor Calibration:** Rankings will be **calibrated among tutors** to ensure that overall grade statistics remain consistent and fair across all students.
- **Group Calibration:** Rankings will be **calibrated within groups of the same tutor**. If a group's grading significantly deviates from the tutor's standards, the grades will be adjusted to maintain consistent grading statistics among all students.

3. **Upcoming Presentation Sessions**

Announcement Details: Information about the **early (pre-A2 due) presentation sessions** will be announced during the **pre-StuVac weekend**. This will include details about the **coordinator** responsible for scheduling the sessions (not me, due to overload).